

TELEVISION

So, what's it gonna be, LED or OLED? 1080p or 4K, does it have to be smart? Can I get a 50-inch panel in my budget? What about the new curved screens, they look awesome!

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The temptation of getting yourself a big screen TV is justified, given the drop in prices and a flurry of cheaper big screen TVs from newer brands making their way into stores. So, where do you start? And, how do you get yourself the right TV(LED TV) that matches your requirement and also fits in your budget? The easiest way to go about doing it is to follow 3 steps- understand what's important for you and what kind of features you want from your new TV, map your requirements to the available options in your budget by building a shortlist. And finally, go to the store, test and try out the TVs that you have short-listed and make the final decision.

In this guide, we shall help you through all the 3 steps while also giving you an easy check-list that you can follow and take along when buying a new TV

Decide on the screen size and resolution: In terms of screen size, you have three clear options - 32, 40/42 and 50+ inches. We strongly recommend you skip the 32-inch screen size unless your budget is too tight or the viewing distance is too short for you to accommodate a larger screen. If any of the two don't apply, don't bother with a 32-inch panel. When choosing between 40/42-inch screens and the larger 50-inch screen size, your

primary decision has to be driven by the viewing distance (the distance between the TV and your seating arrangement) and the screen resolution under consideration (1080p or 4K). Yes 4K is now affordable. While content is still an issue, you could still consider opting for a 4K TV, assuming you would stick to it for 5-8 years. However, please be wary of those ultra low-cost 4K TVs that tease you with their unbelievable price tags (more on this in the next para). A lot has been said on how one cannot make out the difference in image quality between a 4K TV and a 1080p TV at standard viewing distances

(5-9 feet). We humbly disagree with most of those conclusions. You will most certainly realize the difference in terms of image quality between a 4K TV and a 1080p TV provided both are playing the same content in the native resolution of the TV. Though, the maximum impact of 4K or UHD resolution is felt on larger screen sizes (50-inch and above). For anyone considering a 42-inch panel, if going 4K is a part of your consideration, but does not come under the 'must-have' features list, we suggest you buy a good quality 1080p LED TV with local dimming and save that cash to upgrade

